

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4**PART A Group Interaction**

Below is a text about compulsory military service in Switzerland and South Korea:

In around 40 countries in the world today, young people (usually men) are required to spend one or two years in compulsory military service. Switzerland and South Korea are two such countries.

Military service in Switzerland

In 2013, 73% of Switzerland's voters voted to keep the country's compulsory military service. According to Swiss law, male citizens aged between 18 and 34 have to do four months of basic training in the army. About 20,000 men a year attend basic training as a soldier and must be ready for follow-up military training. Many young men complain that the months spent in the army are a waste of time, but older voters say this obligatory duty is the best way to defend the country. Some Swiss men refuse to fulfill their military duties and in this case they can choose to do non-military duties such as environmental projects or work with the elderly.

Military service in South Korea

In South Korea military service lasts as long as two years. Unlike Switzerland, young men who are fit and healthy cannot choose to serve the community instead. Recently, however, the Korean media has highlighted a number of controversial cases involving celebrities who have taken measures to avoid compulsory military service. In 2002, Yoo Seung Jun, a Korean pop singer, became an American citizen to avoid his military duty. Another recent example is MC Mong, a popular singer-rapper accused of avoiding his military service in Korea by having several healthy back teeth removed.

Your group has to prepare for a debate with the motion "Compulsory military service is a good idea". You may want to talk about:

- arguments in favour of compulsory military service
- arguments against compulsory military service
- whether it would be a good idea to introduce compulsory military service for women
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Would you like to be a soldier?
2. Would you prefer to be a soldier or work with the elderly?
3. If you were a soldier, what would you miss most?
4. What kind of person do you think makes a good soldier?
5. Why do you think people in some countries volunteer to join the army?
6. If you had to join the military, which would you choose – the Army, the Navy or the Air Force?
7. Which is more beneficial for the individual – compulsory military service or compulsory social service?
8. Do you think anyone who refuses to do military service should be punished?